

Daily Briefing

Tuesday, October 6, 2026 — Sarasota, FL (7:10 AM EDT)

Calendar

Nothing on the calendar today. The day is open — good day to clear the two overdue items and the EM Founders research question.

One thing to put on your radar: **Surgent's "Tax Policy Hour" premieres today at 2:00 PM ET** (seat reservation is in your Surgent portal). First look at their new tax-policy program.

Email — Personal / Client

Marcus Wells (Xact Books) — "Re: 2025 taxes". Answered your question on Brittany's vehicle: it's a regular auto loan, not a lease. His use split is roughly 30% business / 50% commuting to her W-2 job / 20% personal. He followed up saying he'd call his wife and get you an actual mileage number. **Open loop: you're waiting on Marcus for the number** before you can finalize the business-use allocation (and note the 50% commuting piece is personal, not business).

Amanda Mendenhall (EM Founders Group, General Counsel) — "FW: 501(c)(3) Lobbying Threshold". Re-forwarded the thread from Alex Brigham (TAP Florida) — "this is from the people we met with in Florida about the political committee." Max is copied. **Ask is implied: weigh in on the lobbying-expenditure threshold** for the 501(c)(3) alongside the political committee structure. This has been sitting since Sept 30 and she's nudged it once; worth a reply today even if it's just a timeline.

SouthState Bank — Columbus Day ACH & wire bulletin. Bank is closed **Monday, October 12**; ACH and wire processing shifts accordingly. Worth checking any client payroll or payment runs that land that day and moving them up to Friday the 9th.

Sarasota County Utilities — LATE FEE NOTICE on the Marlowe Dr. account (acct. 100022662, ref. COL0319276). Personal, but it's an actual late fee — quick one to knock out.

IdentoGo / TSA — Michael's TSA PreCheck application was approved; he's eligible and should have his KTN.

Notta support — Request #4271952. Asking whether your issue is resolved before you fill out the survey. Reply if it isn't.

Laurel Oak — 2027 tournament registrations are opening and "Major" save-the-dates are out. No deadline stated yet, but dates fill fast.

Skipped: Costco/Wayfair/Backcountry/Prime Day promos, golf-shaft retail blasts, Word of the Day, health-clickbait newsletters, SiriusXM win-back, Lawngeivity irrigation pitch.

Industry News

Thin morning on the trade-press front, and I want to be straight about why: **my targeted sender searches were blocked this run** (see the note at the bottom), so this section reflects only what was visible in the general inbox sweep rather than a source-by-source scan.

Checkpoint (Thomson Reuters) — nothing new. No Checkpoint mail (checkpoint.riag.com, checkpoint.thomsonreuters.com, taxprof.thomsonreuters.com) appeared in the last 24–48 hours. Flagging it explicitly as checked-and-empty rather than skipped.

Surgent — "Your First Look at the Tax Policy Hour." New recurring tax-policy program, first episode airs **today at 2:00 PM ET**. Registration is through your Surgent portal. If you're carrying CPE hours into Q4, this is an easy one to sit in on while you work.

Accounting Today, CPA Trendlines / CPA Trendlines Academy, CPA Practice Advisor, NATP, Drake Software / Taxing Subjects — no mail from any of these in the window.

Adjacent professional reading that did come in, in case it's useful:

- **WSJ Economics — "The Oil Shock Could Boost the Economy."** Counterintuitive framing on the current crude run-up (WTI is sitting near \$90.60 on the Mideast supply disruption). Also in the issue: AI in science, bias in prediction markets, Greenspan's crisis playbook.
- **WSJ Wealth Adviser — "Banks and the Cycle of Rising Rates."** Bank margin behavior as rates climb, plus consumer spending up and companies pre-announcing layoffs. Relevant to any client conversation about financing costs going into year-end.
- **Weather Channel —** Tropical Storm Isaias may form in the Gulf. Worth a glance given Sarasota.

Tasks

Could not pull your Todoist list this run — the connector call wasn't approved during the automated run. What I can tell you from Todoist's own 6:49 AM digest email: **you have 2 overdue items** for Oct 6. You'll want to open Todoist directly, or approve the connector for future runs (details below).

Focus for Today

An empty calendar on a Tuesday in October is a gift — don't let it get eaten by inbox triage. Three things, in order:

1. **Reply to Amanda** on the 501(c)(3) lobbying threshold, even if the substantive answer needs more time. A one-line "here's when you'll hear from me" ends a week of silence.
2. **Clear the two overdue Todoist items.** Overdue items compound; two is still cheap to fix.
3. **Check client payment runs against Oct 12.** Columbus Day bank closure is the kind of thing that only becomes a problem on the 12th.

Then, if the day holds: the Surgent Tax Policy Hour at 2:00 PM is low-cost professional upkeep.

AI Tip

Make the model show its sources before it shows its answer. When you ask an AI to analyze a client document — a trial balance, a partnership agreement, a prior-year return — add: *"Before you answer, quote the exact lines you're relying on, with their location. Then give your conclusion. If a line you need isn't in the document, say so instead of inferring it."*

This flips the failure mode. Without it, a model that can't find the figure will quietly produce a plausible one. With it, the missing input surfaces as a gap you can go fill, and every number in the conclusion is traceable back to a line you can eyeball in thirty seconds. For tax and attest work, where a confidently wrong number is far worse than an admitted hole, that ordering matters more than any prompt-length trick.

Run notes

Two connectors declined mid-run because no one was available to approve them in an automated session:

- **Gmail search** — only the first inbox query went through. Targeted searches by sender (Checkpoint, Accounting Today, CPA Trendlines, NATP, Drake/Taxing Subjects) and the full-message reads for the Marcus and Amanda threads were refused, so those summaries come from message snippets rather than full bodies.
- **Todoist** — task lookup refused entirely; the overdue count above comes from Todoist's digest email.

If you want these to run unattended, approve the Gmail and Todoist connectors for scheduled tasks.

A PDF version of this briefing was also saved to your AgentHub folder as daily-briefing-2026-10-06.pdf.